THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

MFIN7064 Entrepreneurship in Finance

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GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Prof Anthony Yang (Associate Professor of Practice in Finance, HKU Business School)

Email: Anthony.yang@hku.hk
Office: Room 1002, 10/F., K.K. Leung Building, The University of Hong Kong
Phone: 39175220

Consultation times:

- For group consultations, each group will have a one-hour slot. Group leaders are kindly requested to email the instructor to schedule an appointment.
- For individual consultations, these will be arranged on a case-by-case basis for students who submit a request.

Tutor: TBD
Pre-requisites: N/A
Co-requisites: N/A
Mutually exclusive: e.g. CSIS0278 (mutually exclusive for BUSI0052 Database development & management)

Course Website: TBD
Other important details:

COURSE DESCRIPTION

In an era where innovation reshapes industries, entrepreneurship is the catalyst turning bold dreams into reality. This course invites MSc Finance students to explore the entrepreneurial spirit, learning how to transform ideas into impactful ventures.

Drawing inspiration from visionaries like Steve Jobs and Elon Musk, you'll discover how to identify market opportunities and craft financial roadmaps. Through iconic startup cases and hands-on practice, master the tools to bridge ambition and execution—from financial modeling to investment negotiations. Whether launching a fintech disruptor or scaling a social venture, this course equips you with the mindset to turn ideas into enduring legacies.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. Master techniques for identifying and evaluating entrepreneurial opportunities through market research.
2. Construct basic financial and valuation models for predicting funding needs and project viability.
3. Understand and design key TERMSHEET clauses to balance entrepreneur-investor interests.
4. Develop skills in crafting and presenting investor-focused materials (Teaser, Elevator Pitch).
5. Familiarize with the venture capital decision-making process and basic fundraising strategies.

Programme Learning Outcomes

PLO1. Acquisition of techniques and advanced knowledge in interdisciplinary fields between finance and other appropriate disciplines including but not limited to engineering, law and mathematics

PLO2. Application and integration of knowledge and skills in finance and relevant interdisciplinary fields to identify and tackle practical problems, and design innovative products and systems with international standards and global vision

PLO3. Inculcating leadership, professional ethics and competence in finance and relevant interdisciplinary fields

PLO4. Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES		
Course Learning Outcomes		**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes**
CLO1	Identify potential entrepreneurial opportunities using market analysis tools and assess their feasibility.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO4
CLO2	Build basic financial models to forecast funding requirements and value startup projects.	PLO1,PLO2
CLO3	Design foundational TERMSHEET clauses to protect entrepreneurial interests.	PLO1, PLO2
CLO4	Create and deliver effective Teasers and Elevator Pitches to communicate project value.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3, PLO4
CLO5	Understand the venture capital fundraising process and design basic fundraising strategies.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3, PLO4

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	**Expected contact hour**	**Study Load (% of study)**
TLA1 Lectures: Core concepts in entrepreneurial finance (opportunity identification, financial modeling basics)	30	25%
TLA2 Group case analyses: Real-world startup cases for market analysis and financial forecasting	30	25%
TLA3 Workshops: TERMSHEET clause design and simulated negotiations	30	25%
TLA4 Practical drills: Teaser and Elevator Pitch composition and presentation	15	12.5%
TLA5 Group discussions: Fundraising process decomposition and strategy design	15	12.5%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	**Brief Description (Optional)**	**Weight**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
A1 Teaser Writing & Presentation	Craft and present a 3-minute investor-focused project teaser	10%	CLO4
A2 Elevator Pitch Video	Record a 5-minute individual pitch of a startup idea	10%	CLO4
A3 Group Business Plan	Submit a comprehensive plan including market analysis, financial forecasts, etc.	40%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
A4 Group Presentation	Live pitch of the business plan with Q&A	20%	CLO1-CLO5
A5 Peer Evaluation	Team members' assessment of individual contributions	10%	CLO5
Class Performance	Include submission of assignments, participation of class discussion, etc	10%	
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT	
Course Grade Descriptors	
A+, A, A-	Exceeds course requirements with exceptional performance and innovative application.
B+, B, B-	Meets requirements with solid performance in applying concepts.
C+, C, C-	Partially meets requirements; requires improvement in knowledge application.
D+, D	Fails to meet basic requirements in multiple areas.
F	Substantially fails to demonstrate understanding of core concepts.

Assessment Rubrics for Each Assessment

A1 Teaser Writing & Presentation

Grade	Description
A+, A, A-	• Delivers a compelling teaser with precise focus on core value proposition, market pain points, and unique solutions • Follows a gold-standard structure (Problem-Solution-Value) with perfect information density and logical flow • Supported by rigorous data (e.g., target market size, quantified competitive edge) and innovative highlights • Exhibits articulate language, polished visual aids (e.g., infographics), and strong audience engagement
B+, B, B-	• Clearly presents project fundamentals with complete articulation of market opportunity and business model • Adheres to basic narrative logic with no critical information missing, though lacking innovative elements • Relies on reasonable data to demonstrate feasibility • Delivers fluently with standard visual materials and minimal presentation flaws
C+, C, C-	• Covers major components but with blurred focus and superficial market analysis • Contains logical gaps or missing critical data with limited persuasiveness • Exhibits frequent delivery breakups，rudimentary visual aids, and poor interaction
D+, D	• Fails to present basic project framework with confused value proposition • Contains obvious factual errors or logical contradictions • Significantly exceeds length limit or deviates from requirements
F	• Plagiarizes others' work or completely deviates from the theme • Submission missing or content unrecognizable

A2 Elevator Pitch Video

Grade	Description
A+, A, A-	• Conveys the "unreplaceability" of the startup idea within 5 minutes, forming a closed-loop argument from user needs to competitive barriers • Employs storytelling narrative with skillful integration of pain point scenarios (e.g., user interview clips) and data validation (e.g., pilot results) • Delivers with compelling charisma, professional body language, and smooth video editing • Ends with a persuasive call to action that ignites investor interest
B+, B, B-	• Comprehensively explains business model, market positioning, and competitive advantages • Maintains clear structure but lacks narrative tension and sufficient data support • Delivers naturally with basic video production standards • Effectively communicates project value but lacks memorability
C+, C, C-	• Read scripts and present without passion • Covers basic elements but with unclear priorities and shallow market analysis • Contains logical leaps or missing critical components (e.g., ambiguous monetization model) • Exhibits delivery with poor video/audio quality
D+, D	• Read scripts and present without passion • Presents unclear core business logic, failing to demonstrate feasibility • Video content significantly deviates from requirements or technical flaws render it unwatchable
F	• Plagiarized content or complete disregard for assignment guidelines • Unsubmitted or content indecipherable

A3 Group Business Plan

Grade	Description
A+, A, A-	• Conducts thorough market analysis with innovative segmentation and rigorous competitor benchmarking • Develops a robust financial model with accurate revenue/cost forecasts and sensitivity analysis • Designs balanced TERMSHEET clauses with clear rationale for equity allocation and investor protections • Presents cohesive strategies with actionable milestones and risk mitigation plans
B+, B, B-	• Completes market analysis with feasible business model and reasonable financial projections • Includes standard TERMSHEET clauses with basic justification for key terms • Outlines clear strategies but with limited innovation or depth in risk assessment

C+, C, C-	• Performs superficial market analysis with generic business model frameworks • Contains financial forecasts with missing assumptions or inconsistent logic • Includes basic TERMSHEET clauses without clear alignment to project needs
D+, D	• Submits disjointed content with critical sections (e.g., financials, market analysis) missing • Presents fundamentally flawed business logic or unviable financial projections
F	• Plagiarized content or failure to address core assignment requirements

A4 Group Presentation

Grade	Description
A+, A, A-	• Delivers a dynamic pitch integrating market insights, financial rigor, and strategic vision • Responds to Q&A with precise, data-driven answers and demonstrates deep domain knowledge • Exhibits seamless team coordination, with each member contributing coherently to the narrative • Uses innovative visualizations and real-time data demonstrations to enhance persuasiveness
B+, B, B-	• Presents comprehensive business plan with clear articulation of key components • Answers most questions accurately with basic data support • Maintains team coherence with structured role assignments
C+, C, C-	• Covers basic plan elements but with inconsistent messaging or superficial explanations • Struggles with technical questions or provides vague responses • Shows limited team coordination with disjointed delivery
D+, D	• Fails to present core business plan elements or delivers incoherent content • Cannot address fundamental questions about market viability or financials
F	• No show for the presentation or content entirely irrelevant to the plan

A5 Peer Evaluation

Grade	Description
A+, A, A-	• Provides detailed, constructive feedback with specific examples of individual contributions/shortcomings • Demonstrates objective assessment of team dynamics, workload distribution, and collaborative impact • Aligns evaluations with project milestones and clearly identifies value-added contributions
B+, B, B-	• Submits complete evaluations with reasonable feedback on team members' performance • Recognizes key contributions but lacks granularity in specific examples
C+, C, C-	• Submits cursory evaluations with generic comments (e.g., "good job") • Fails to link feedback to specific tasks or project phases
D+, D	• Submits biased evaluations with personal attacks or vague complaints • Provides minimal feedback insufficient for team performance assessment
F	• Fails to submit the evaluation or provides blatantly fraudulent assessments

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Lecture	Topic	Readings/Watching	Cases/Assignment
1	• Course introduction and logistics • Startup Idea Generation & Entrepreneurial Opportunity Identification • Market Research Basics	Textbook A: Chapter 1	Group formation Shortlist 3 startup ideas and process with opportunity verification test
2	• Introduction to Business Plan • Market Segmentation & Target Customers • Understand Business Model	Textbook B: Chapter 1, 3, 4	Case: Restaurant Business Plan Assignment: Market Segmentation & Target Customers
3	• Feasibility Analysis • Understand competition	Textbook B: Chapter 3	Assignment: Valuation exercise (Spreadsheet)
4	• Financial Plan • Revenue & Cost Forecasting	Textbook A: Chapter 7 Textbook B: Chapter 4	Individual: single-store revenue model
5	• Valuation of New Ventures	Textbook A: Chapter 8	Case: Angel investment valuation Assignment: Valuation exercise (Spreadsheet)
6	• Funding Requirement Planning • Cash Flow Management	Textbook A: Chapter 2~5	Case: Early-stage cash crisis Assignment: Cash Flow Statement

	• Sources of funding		
7	• Prepare your business plan • Promote your business • Teaser Writing Techniques & Practice • Elevator Pitch Structure & Delivery	Textbook B: Chapter 5 & Appendix III Successful Teaser examples TED-style presentation cases	Assignment: Group: BP collaboration plan Individual: Executive summary & Teaser Record: pitch video (⩽5 minutes)
8	• TERMSHEET Clauses • Negotiating with investors	Textbook A: Chapter 9	Workshops: TERMSHEET clause design and simulated negotiations
9	• Venture Capital Decision Process & Fundraising Strategies • Business Plan Integration & Mock Pitching	Textbook B: Chapter 5 Business plan template	Group discussions: Fundraising process decomposition and strategy design
10	• Final project presentation		Group: submit final plan & mock pitch

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

1. **Textbook**:

   A. *Entrepreneurial Finance: The Art and Science of Growing Ventures* (Luisa Alemany, Cambridge Press)

   B. *How to Create a Successful Business Plan: For Entrepreneurs, Scientists, Managers and Students* (Dan Galai & Lior Hillel & Daphna Wiener, World Scientific Books 2016)

2. **Case Pack**: *Practical Cases in Entrepreneurial Finance* (various materials to be provided during the course)

3. **Software**: Excel for financial modeling (basic training provided).

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- ✓ conducting mid-term survey in additional to SFTL around the end of the semester
- ✓ Online response via Moodle site
- ✓ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

1) Verbal feedback during class discussions and drills

2) Written feedback on assignments within 2 weeks of submission

3) Online feedback via Moodle for revised assignments

4) Mid-course progress review in Week 5

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty are strictly enforced. Plagiarism, cheating, or unauthorized collaboration will result in an automatic F grade and further disciplinary actions. Academic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, presenting others' ideas as one's own, cheating on exams, or unauthorized access to exam materials. All sources must be properly cited, and group work must specify individual contributions.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

1. **Attendance Policy: Minimum 70% attendance required; prior approval needed for absences.**
2. **Assignment Submission: All work must be submitted on time; 5% daily late penalty.**